internationally employed to draw interstate boundaries, refrained from making expansive territorial claims, and stopped its bullying tactics.[50]

For safeguarding territorial integrity, the Nehru government took a series of steps to improve administration, enhance development and communications infrastructure, and intensify monitoring by beefing up the armed constabulary and deploying the army. In early 1960, it established a committee in the Cabinet Secretariat to coordinate development programmes with considerable emphasis on communications and infrastructure. In the Third Five-Year Plan beginning 1961, it considerably enhanced allocations for constructing infrastructure in Ladakh and doubled the previous plan's appropriations for NEFA. For coordinating the road-building programmes of individual states with what the Army drew up after it was made responsible for border security, the Indian government created the Border Roads Development Board (BRDB) in March 1960. Soon thereafter, it also raised the semi-military General Reserve Engineering Force, which freed the overburdened Army Engineering Corps to focus upon the construction of vital bridges. Tasked with constructing 2500 miles of new roads and improving 1500 miles of existing ones by 1963, the BRDB initiated or completed several projects in NEFA, North Assam, Sikkim, Bhutan, and Ladakh. At the same time, given the intimate links between India's security and the security of the Himalayan states, the Indian government enhanced its economic assistance and reiterated its military commitments to Bhutan, Nepal, and Sikkim. It granted roughly USD six million to Sikkim in 1959, more than half of which was earmarked for transportation and communication. In the same year, India doubled its annual subsidy to Bhutan and agreed to bear the cost of five all-weather roads between the two countries. Two years later,